

# PUBLIC SUBMISSION

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Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

**Comment On:** NSF\_FRDOC\_0001-3479

Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

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## General Comment

A Freedom First Doctrine for American AI

AI is rapidly advancing to become a paradigm shifting technology that will have a transformative impact on America's economy, government, citizens, and position within the global order. In the months and years to come, American leadership will make decisions involving capital allocation, strategic mobilization, global trade, (de)regulation, and more that will determine the nature of these impacts on our country, and the world. This memo proposes a simple doctrine to ground these decisions in a singular principle: Freedom.

The Freedom First doctrine mandates that Freedom be the north star of our national approach to AI. Freedom is the bold declaration of individual sovereignty our country was built on—the inalienable right for all people to speak free, think free, act free, and live free in pursuit of the future they want; unencumbered by the heavy hand of government, and limited only by others equal right to do the same.

We must ensure that AI's preeminent impact is the protection and amplification of this American freedom. Strategically, this means making two things simultaneously true:

- 1) America must not lose the AI arms race – American AI must always be the best in the world, and superintelligence should not be created outside of America first.
- 2) American AI must serve American freedom – We must ensure American AI serves to protect, amplify, and never subvert American's freedom.

Failure to achieve either of these would be catastrophic. But since significant focus is already being placed on (1), suggestions related to it are omitted from this memo. The strongest point we aim to communicate is that ensuring (2), and doing so WITHOUT slowing progress towards (1), will require an aggressive, focused effort in and of itself. And while aspects of (2) may draw on expertise often found among "AI safety" experts who argue for slowing down AI progress, the central ethos behind (2) must be one of relentless acceleration to keep up.

To accomplish this, we suggest launching a coordinated national effort via a new National Institute that:

- Operates under an executive mandate to ensure American AI serves to protect, amplify, and never subvert American's freedom.
- Has sufficient funding to attract and motivate the absolute best people to work extremely hard.
- Is structured to operate with maximum efficiency, minimum bureaucratic overhead, and radically transparent accountability.
- Receives full situational awareness on the state and progress of leading AI efforts.
- Explicitly lacks unilateral power to regulate or obstruct progress towards ensuring America does not lose the AI arms race.

It is likely best that this Institute maintain maximum autonomy to identify the efforts most likely to deliver on its mandate. But, some example efforts this Institute might choose to execute are:

- Establish a data-driven system for measuring and predicting the impact of AI and adjacent technologies on concrete dimensions of American freedom – including economic opportunity, personal autonomy, and democratic agency.
- Identify and execute on the most promising strategies targeting how AI can create new economic opportunities in lower- and middle-class communities.
- Implement efficient deliberative mechanisms for rotating, representative citizen panels to provide non-partisan democratic input on AI

development, policy, and evaluation.

- Leverage bridging algorithms like Community Notes along with representative citizen panels to ensure the notions of Freedom the institute focuses on remain non-partisan.
- Create a National AI Infrastructure providing all Americans baseline access to advanced AI capabilities, preventing freedom-limiting digital divides.
- Develop mechanisms to measure if an AI system's actions are aligned with the will of the American people.

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## **Attachments**

A Freedom First Doctrine for AI in America

## A Freedom First Doctrine for American AI

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